

BATTLE OF HOTH

ADVANCED

An expert variant & expansion — new command deck, on-board leaders, and units

For experienced players of the base game. This variant keeps the same board, dice, command-card economy, and victory medals — and layers expert decision-making on top: reaction cards played on the opponent's turn, combo and escalation cards, characters who fight on the board, and two new units.

Unofficial fan content. Original rules & design © their authors (CC BY 4.0); built on *Star Wars: Battle of Hoth* © & ™ Lucasfilm Ltd. / Days of Wonder.

1 • What's New

The Advanced variant adds four things, all expressed in the base game's own terms:

- **A redesigned command deck** (~24 cards/side) — see §5.
- **On-board leaders** — six characters who ride with a unit, inspire those around them, and can be hunted down (§4).
- **Two new units** — the Rebel Tauntaun Scout and the Imperial AT-ST (§3).
- **Destroyable structures** — shield generators and the ion cannon become objectives you can blast apart in the scenarios that feature them.

Everything else — setup, movement, line of sight, terrain, attacking, retreats, and winning by victory medals — works exactly as in the base rulebook.

Core new mechanics

- **Sector-locked orders (kept from the base game).** Most ordering cards name a sector (Probe / Raid / Assault — Left, Center, or Right) and you may act only there. If you have no units in that sector, the card is wasted. Only two cards per side let you choose freely (Coordinated Command, Grand Offensive). This preserves the game's central "you can't always act where you want" tension.
- **Reaction cards.** Held in hand and played on the *opponent's* turn when their trigger occurs (e.g. Ambush, Evasive Maneuvers, Suppressing Fire). They are not played on your own turn.
- **Escalation cards.** Their strength scales with the score — Desperate Valor arms the Rebels as they fall behind; Crush Them sharpens the Empire as it pulls ahead.
- **Unit-type fallback.** If a card that orders a specific unit type finds none of that type, instead order 1 unit of your choice (with no bonus).

2 · How to Adopt This Variant

This variant is built on a copy of the base game — you don't replace it, you extend it. Here is the checklist to get an Advanced game to the table.

1. Start with the base game

Use your **Battle of Hoth** board, miniatures, terrain hexes, symbol dice, and victory medals, and pick a battle from the scenario book. Set up the scenario exactly as printed — its hand size, first player, and victory conditions are unchanged.

2. Build the Advanced command decks (the one thing you must make)

The Advanced deck **replaces the base command deck**. Choose any one of:

- **Print & cut** the card tiles in §5 onto cardstock at 100% scale, or
- **Sleeve** the printed tiles in front of any same-size cards, or
- **Hand-write** the cards onto blank/index cards from the text in §5.

Each side needs its **23-card base deck** (13 section + 10 tactic). Keep the two decks separate — the Rebel and Imperial tactic cards differ. Shuffle each and draw to the scenario's hand size.

3. (Optional) Add leaders

- Each player picks **one** leader from their faction (choices are open) and shuffles that leader's **3 cards** into their deck.
- Mark the leader's **escort unit** with a distinctive token — a coin, a colored ring, or a spare figure — so both players can see which unit carries the leader.
- Honor the **escort lock**: a leader may be fielded only if its escort type is in the scenario (Luke→Snowspeeder, Han→Tauntaun, Leia→Echo trooper, Vader→Snowtrooper, Veers→AT-AT). **Piett** needs no figure — he is off-board.

4. Proxy the new units (when a scenario uses them)

There are no Tauntaun or AT-ST miniatures in the base box — use any stand-in figures or tokens (Tauntaun Scout = a 2-figure cavalry unit; AT-ST = a 2-figure walker). The standard booklet scenarios don't require them, so add them to your own scenarios or substitute them in for variety.

5. Structures

For scenarios that feature a shield generator or ion cannon, use the base game's structure pieces as **destroyable objectives**: a unit may attack one by normal rules, and a single **Blast** destroys it. Note which structures are objectives before you start.

Recommended first game

Play **Scenario 1 (Imperial Scout Mission)** with the Advanced decks and *no* leaders to learn the new cards. Then add one leader each and try a scenario with vehicles (e.g. Snowspeeder Counter-Attack) to see leaders, auras, and the new units in action.

Printing tip: print §5 at 100% (turn off "fit to page"), on cardstock or in sleeves; the tiles are laid out two per row for easy cutting.

3 · New Units

Two units fill the gaps between the existing light and heavy pieces. Proxy with any suitable figures — there are no tauntaun or AT-ST minis in the base box.

Tauntaun Scout — Rebel light cavalry

Figures	2 (mounted riders)
Hit on	Infantry symbol or Blast
Move	0–3 hexes; may still attack after moving up to 2
Attack	3 dice in close combat; 1 die at range 2
Special	All-terrain (ignores the first "must stop" each turn); after attacking it may move 1 hex (hit-and-run). Eliminating it grants a victory medal.

Fast skirmishers that harry the flanks and vanish — the mount for Han Solo in the leader rules.

AT-ST — Imperial scout walker (medium armor)

Figures	2 (one walker that soaks two hits)
Hit on	Vehicle symbol or Blast
Move	0–2 hexes; may still attack after moving
Attack	3 / 3 / 2 dice at range 1 / 2 / 3
Special	May climb onto ridges (the AT-AT cannot); no AT-AT confirmation rule and it retreats normally, so it is far easier to kill than an AT-AT. Grants a medal.

A nimble walker that takes ground and contests objectives — General Veers' lighter companion.

Full unit roster

Unit	Side	Figs	Move	Attack	Hit on	Notes
Echo Base Trooper	Rebel	3	1 / 2	3 / 2 / 1	inf, blast	baseline infantry
Tauntaun Scout	Rebel	2	3	3 / 1	inf, blast	cavalry; hit-and-run
Snowspeeder	Rebel	3	3	4 / 2	veh, blast	flying; crosses crevasses
Rebel Artillery	Rebel	1	0	1 / 3 / 3	blast	no move; no medal
Snowtrooper	Empire	4	1 / 2	3 / 2 / 1	inf, blast	baseline infantry
Probe Droid	Empire	2	2	2 / 1	blast	recon; no medal
AT-ST	Empire	2	2	3 / 3 / 2	veh, blast	medium walker; climbs ridges
AT-AT	Empire	1	1	3 / 3 / 3	veh, blast	confirmation kill; ignores retreats

4 • Advanced Leaders

In the base game a leader is just three command cards. Here each leader is also a **character figure on the board** that rides with a unit (its *escort*), strengthens it, projects an aura to nearby friendlies, and can be hunted down.

- **Open selection.** Each player picks one leader from their faction; choices are open.
- **Escort lock.** A leader can be fielded only if a unit of its escort type is in the scenario; otherwise that leader sits out entirely. Piett is the exception — off-board, always available.
- **Deploy** the figure with one of your escort-type units after forces are placed.
- **Transfer.** When you order the escort you may instead move the leader 1 hex to join another friendly unit.
- **Capture (Bonus Medals).** If the escort is destroyed, the leader escapes to an adjacent friendly unit; if isolated, the opponent scores the leader's Bonus Medal.

Luke Skywalker

Rogue Leader — pilots a Snowspeeder

On the board. Escort rolls +1 die and may reroll one die (the Force); ignores 1 Retreat against it. Aura (1 hex): friendly units may ignore 1 Retreat. Bonus Medal 2.

Cards. Force Push, Trust Your Feelings, Heroic Resolve.

Han Solo

On a Tauntaun Scout

On the board. Escort rolls +1 die and may reroll one die. Aura (1 hex): friendly units +1 movement. Bonus Medal 1.

Cards. Never Tell Me the Odds, Surprise Attack, Covering Fire.

Leia Organa

Command squad (4-figure Echo Base unit)

On the board. Her squad rolls +1 die and, if it does not attack, returns 1 figure (rally). Bonus Medal 2.

Cards. Coordinated Defense, New Hope, Deploy the Fleet.

Darth Vader

Sith Lord — on foot with a Snowtrooper unit

On the board. +2 dice in close combat; his attacks treat Retreats as hits and ignore the target's terrain cover. Aura — Fear (1 hex): adjacent enemies roll 1 fewer die. Survives his escort's death as a lone figure (worth 2 if killed).

Cards. Force Choke, Lack of Faith, Power of the Dark Side.

General Veers

Commands an AT-AT ("Blizzard 1")

On the board. His walker rolls +1 die; all friendly vehicles roll +1 die in close combat. Bonus Medal 1.

Cards. Concentrate All Fire, Maximum Firepower, Break Their Lines.

Admiral Piett

Off-board — Fleet Command (no figure)

On the board. You hold +1 command card; once a game, call his orbital bombardment. No aura, cannot be captured. Bonus Medal 0.

Cards. Orbital Bombardment, Tactical Redeployment, Special Orders.

5 · The Advanced Command Deck — Print & Play

The cards below are sized to a standard **59 × 91 mm** playing-card and laid out three per row. Print at **100% scale** (turn off "fit to page") on cardstock and cut along the card borders; sleeve them if you like.

- **Every copy is included.** Each card appears exactly as many times as its deck needs (e.g. Speeder Strike appears twice) — just print a deck's pages and cut, no photocopying.
- The **Rebel** and **Empire** decks each include their own copy of the 13 section cards (identical between sides); the footer names which deck each card belongs to.
- **Colour code:** slate = section cards · red = Rebel · blue = Empire · leader cards name their leader in the footer.

Rebel Alliance deck — print these 24 cards

Probe Left	Probe Center	Probe Right
<i>Section card · left sector</i>	<i>Section card · center sector</i>	<i>Section card · right sector</i>
Order 1 unit in the left sector.	Order 1 unit in the center sector.	Order 1 unit in the right sector.
SECTION · REBEL DECK	SECTION · REBEL DECK	SECTION · REBEL DECK

Raid Left	Raid Center	Raid Right
<i>Section card · left sector</i>	<i>Section card · center sector</i>	<i>Section card · right sector</i>
Order 2 units in the left sector.	Order 2 units in the center sector.	Order 2 units in the right sector.
SECTION · REBEL DECK	SECTION · REBEL DECK	SECTION · REBEL DECK
Assault Left	Assault Center	Assault Right
<i>Section card · left sector</i>	<i>Section card · center sector</i>	<i>Section card · right sector</i>
Order 3 units in the left sector.	Order 3 units in the center sector.	Order 3 units in the right sector.
SECTION · REBEL DECK	SECTION · REBEL DECK	SECTION · REBEL DECK

Recon in Force	Pincer Movement	Coordinated Command
<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
Order 1 unit in EACH section (left, center, and right).	Order 2 units in EACH flank (left and right; the center is skipped).	Order up to 4 units anywhere on the battlefield.
SECTION · REBEL DECK	SECTION · REBEL DECK	SECTION · REBEL DECK
Grand Offensive	Speeder Strike	Speeder Strike
<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
Choose a flank. Order ALL of your units there; each ordered unit gains +1 movement this turn.	Order up to 2 Snowspeeder units. After it attacks, each may move 1 hex (hit-and-run). <i>Fallback: if you command no vehicle units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>	Order up to 2 Snowspeeder units. After it attacks, each may move 1 hex (hit-and-run). <i>Fallback: if you command no vehicle units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>
SECTION · REBEL DECK	REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC	REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC

Trench Fighting	Artillery Barrage	Focus Fire
<i>Command card</i> Choose a section. Order up to 3 infantry units there. They roll +1 attack die and ignore terrain attack penalties this turn. <i>Fallback: if you command no infantry units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>	<i>Command card</i> Order 1 Rebel Artillery unit. It attacks twice this turn. <i>Fallback: if you command no special units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>	<i>Command card</i> Choose a section. Order up to 3 units there. For each unit after the first that attacks the SAME target, that attack rolls +1 die.
REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC	REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC	REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC
Desperate Valor	Forward Command	Regroup
<i>Command card</i> Order up to 2 units. Each rolls +1 attack die for every victory medal the enemy has scored (max +3).	<i>Command card</i> Order 1 unit. Then draw 2 extra command cards.	<i>Command card</i> Order up to 2 units. Each ordered unit that does NOT attack returns 1 lost figure to full-strength cap.
REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC	REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC	REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC

Evasive Maneuvers	Ambush	Tauntaun Recon
<i>Reaction card</i>	<i>Reaction card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
REACTION (play on the enemy turn). When an enemy declares an attack on your Snowspeeder, it may first move 1 hex; recompute the attack.	REACTION. When an enemy unit ends its move adjacent to one of your units, that unit immediately makes a close-combat attack.	Order up to 2 units. Each gains +1 movement; then draw 1 command card.
REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC	REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC	REBEL ALLIANCE · TACTIC

Galactic Empire deck — print these 24 cards

Probe Left	Probe Center	Probe Right
<i>Section card · left sector</i>	<i>Section card · center sector</i>	<i>Section card · right sector</i>
Order 1 unit in the left sector.	Order 1 unit in the center sector.	Order 1 unit in the right sector.
SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK	SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK	SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK

Raid Left	Raid Center	Raid Right
<i>Section card · left sector</i>	<i>Section card · center sector</i>	<i>Section card · right sector</i>
Order 2 units in the left sector.	Order 2 units in the center sector.	Order 2 units in the right sector.
SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK	SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK	SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK
Assault Left	Assault Center	Assault Right
<i>Section card · left sector</i>	<i>Section card · center sector</i>	<i>Section card · right sector</i>
Order 3 units in the left sector.	Order 3 units in the center sector.	Order 3 units in the right sector.
SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK	SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK	SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK

Recon in Force	Pincer Movement	Coordinated Command
<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
Order 1 unit in EACH section (left, center, and right).	Order 2 units in EACH flank (left and right; the center is skipped).	Order up to 4 units anywhere on the battlefield.
SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK	SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK	SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK
Grand Offensive	Armored Advance	Armored Advance
<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
Choose a flank. Order ALL of your units there; each ordered unit gains +1 movement this turn.	Order up to 2 AT-AT units. Each gains +1 movement and +1 die in close combat. <i>Fallback: if you command no vehicle units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>	Order up to 2 AT-AT units. Each gains +1 movement and +1 die in close combat. <i>Fallback: if you command no vehicle units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>
SECTION · IMPERIAL DECK	GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC	GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC

Trooper Assault	Concentrated Fire	Hold the Line
<i>Command card</i> Choose a section. Order up to 3 snowtrooper units there. Each rolls +1 attack die. <i>Fallback: if you command no infantry units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>	<i>Command card</i> Choose a section. Order up to 3 units there. The 2nd unit to attack a given target rolls +1 die; the 3rd rolls +2 dice.	<i>Command card</i> Order up to 2 units anywhere. They may not move, but each rolls +1 die in close combat (defensive firing line).
GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC	GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC	GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC
Probe Recon	Crush Them	Forward Command
<i>Command card</i> Order up to 2 Probe Droid units. Each gains +1 movement; your units roll +1 die against any enemy a droid can see. <i>Fallback: if you command no special units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>	<i>Command card</i> Order up to 2 units anywhere. Each rolls +1 die for every enemy unit currently below half strength (max +3).	<i>Command card</i> Order 1 unit. Then draw 2 extra command cards.
GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC	GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC	GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC

Suppressing Fire	Imperial Ambush	Cold Assault
<i>Reaction card</i>	<i>Reaction card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
REACTION. When an enemy attacks one of your infantry units in cover, the attacker rolls 1 fewer die.	REACTION. When an enemy unit ends its move adjacent to one of your units, that unit immediately makes a close-combat attack.	Choose a section. Order up to 2 snowtrooper units there. Each gains +1 movement and may move its full distance and still attack. <i>Fallback: if you command no infantry units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>
GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC	GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC	GALACTIC EMPIRE · TACTIC

Leader cards — add a leader's 3 cards to your deck if you field that leader

Force Push	Trust Your Feelings	Heroic Resolve
<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
Order 1 unit. On its attack, Retreat results also count as hits.	Order up to 2 units. Each rolls +1 die and may reroll its missed dice once.	Order 1 unit. It attacks twice this turn.
REBEL LEADER · LUKE SKYWALKER	REBEL LEADER · LUKE SKYWALKER	REBEL LEADER · LUKE SKYWALKER

Never Tell Me the Odds	Surprise Attack	Covering Fire
<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
Order 2 units in two different sections. Each gains +2 movement.	Order 1 unit. It may move its full distance and still attack, rolling +1 die.	Order up to 3 units. Focus fire: +1 die for each unit after the first to attack the same target.
REBEL LEADER · HAN SOLO	REBEL LEADER · HAN SOLO	REBEL LEADER · HAN SOLO
Coordinated Defense	New Hope	Deploy the Fleet
<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
Order up to 3 units. Each ordered unit that does not attack returns 1 lost figure.	Order up to 4 units. Each rolls +1 attack die.	Order 1 unit. Draw 3 extra command cards.
REBEL LEADER · LEIA ORGANA	REBEL LEADER · LEIA ORGANA	REBEL LEADER · LEIA ORGANA

Force Choke	Lack of Faith	Power of the Dark Side
<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
Order 1 unit. It rolls +1 die and Retreat results also count as hits.	Order up to 2 units. Each rolls +1 die; the enemy may not play reaction cards this turn.	Order 1 unit. It attacks twice, each attack rolling +1 die.
IMPERIAL LEADER · DARTH VADER	IMPERIAL LEADER · DARTH VADER	IMPERIAL LEADER · DARTH VADER
Concentrate All Fire	Maximum Firepower	Break Their Lines
<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>	<i>Command card</i>
Order 1 AT-AT unit. It attacks twice this turn. <i>Fallback: if you command no vehicle units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>	Order up to 2 vehicle units. Each rolls +1 die and gains +1 movement. <i>Fallback: if you command no vehicle units, instead order 1 unit of your choice (no bonus).</i>	Order up to 3 units. After attacking, each may move 1 hex (breakthrough).
IMPERIAL LEADER · GENERAL VEERS	IMPERIAL LEADER · GENERAL VEERS	IMPERIAL LEADER · GENERAL VEERS

Orbital Bombardment	Tactical Redeployment	Special Orders
<i>Command card</i> Do not order units. Roll 2 dice against EACH of up to 3 enemy units; blasts (and matching symbols) hit, ignoring cover and line of sight.	<i>Command card</i> Order up to 4 units. Each gains +1 movement.	<i>Command card</i> Order 1 unit. Draw 2 extra command cards.
IMPERIAL LEADER · ADMIRAL PIETT	IMPERIAL LEADER · ADMIRAL PIETT	IMPERIAL LEADER · ADMIRAL PIETT

6 · Quick Reference

Attack dice (6 faces)

- **Infantry** symbol — a hit on an infantry target.
- **Vehicle** symbol — a hit on a vehicle target.
- **Blast** — a hit on *any* target (and the only thing that hits special units and destroys structures).
- **Retreat** — the target retreats 1 hex (no figure lost unless it cannot retreat).
- **Miss** (×2 faces) — no effect.

Turn sequence

- Play one command card.
- Order the units it allows.
- Move ordered units.
- Attack with ordered units.
- Resolve any reactions, then draw a card.

Winning

Score victory medals by eliminating enemy units (and via each scenario's special objectives — exits, held hexes, captured leaders, destroyed structures). First to the scenario's medal target, or a sudden-death condition, wins.

Canonical rules text lives in the project's markdown documents; this PDF is a formatted, print-ready edition. Unofficial fan variant.